

Tips For Shooting Close-ups

Macro shooting involves shooting objects up-close, such as the nib of a pen or a flower petal. Most digital cameras offer a macro mode, where the user is needed to maintain a certain distance between the camera and the subject.

Maintaining minimum distance is necessary because each digital camera has a limit beyond which it cannot focus. This distance is mentioned in the camera manual. It is usually 4 cm for entry-level cameras. It is advisable to use a tripod, if possible, and the LCD screen of the camera, instead of its optical viewfinder.

As a rule, capturing small objects is difficult and calls for some personal, quality time with a camera before commencing the actual shoot. This will help you gauge the distance that your camera can operate best from. Play about with the manual settings such as white balance, shutter speed, exposure, etc.



The small grains on a leaf captured by Casio's EX-Z30 in this picture were no bigger than 0.5mm

pack. The software box in the corner was well-focused and the text was clearly visible.

The Orite VC-R500 and VC-5000Z returned very crisp images with no unnecessary noise or colour casts. The text in the corner was well-focused, and the colours of the boxes, too, were quite impressive.

The Samsung Digimax 370 was simply disappointing. The image was out of focus and dark. The red colour of the motherboard looked different, and the small components just didn't show up because the image was out of focus. The Creative DC-CAM 3200Z, too, returned an image that was not up to the mark, and the same was the case with the Olympus Camedia C-310Zoom.

Extreme close-ups need lots of patience, stable hands, and a focused mind. This macro test required us to move back and forth to get a leaf in focus. Casio's clarity was simply superb at picking up the tiny grains on the leaf. The Sony P73 was also impressive. The Nikon Coolpix 4100 gave us a hard time in getting the focus right. But our perseverance paid off. The image it captured was perfect.

Final Thoughts

The 19 cameras tested in this category had, more or less, the same specifications. Their prices ranged from Rs 9,000 to Rs 20,000.

Our tests made it obvious that you get what you

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